'Round the Mountainside

Quarterly newsletter for Coolfont Mountainside Association

Summer 2022

Annual Membership Meeting

from CMA Board



The Annual Membership Meeting will be held on Saturday, September 24, 2022 at 10:00 am at Coolfont Resort. After two years of virtual membership meetings, we're looking forward to an in-person event this year - provided there are no changes in COVID protocols.

Watch for details on the meeting, including an agenda in the CMA Google Group in September. Also, **please watch your email inbox** around the beginning of September. CMA will be sending an email to the primary contact for each property with information about the Annual Membership Meeting and Election. It will include supporting materials for the meeting and statements from each of the candidates running for the CMA Board.

You will receive a second email when the voting system is open to accept member ballots. **It is very important that all owners/members participate in online voting in order to obtain a meeting quorum**. Owners will elect three members to the CMA Board and cast their votes on the 2023 Proposed Budgets, 2022 Annual Membership Meeting Minutes, and other Association business.

Please be sure we have a current email address for your account. If you're not certain your email is up to date, please contact the Communications Committee (see last page).

Pool Closing

The CMA pool will remain open through Labor Day. This year the holiday falls on Monday, September 5.

Weather permitting, this represents the last day that the pool will be open and available for the CMA community to use and enjoy.

UPCOMING EVENTS

Board of Directors Meeting	Sat., August 13, 10:00 am	Coolfont Resort
Pot Luck Dinner	Sat., August 13, 6:30 pm	i Ponti Vecchi, Q-4
CMA Annual Membership Meeting	Sat., September 24, 10:00 am	Coolfont Resort
Pot Luck Brunch	Sat., October 1, 9:00 am	Great Paws Lodge, G-5
Loop the Loop Family Fun Run & Walk	Sat., October 1, 11:00 am	Outside the Barn
Board of Directors Meeting	Mon., October 17, 6:30 m	Zoom teleconfernece

Please check the Google Group or Facebook Group for confirmation of date, time, and location.

Save a Little $$$!

Just a reminder that Morgan County provides a nice discount (2.5%) if you pay your property taxes and fire and ambulance fees before September 1. For information on your tax bills and the early payment discount, contact the Morgan County Sheriff's Tax Office at 304-258-8562 or visit morgancountywv.gov/taxoffice.

Host a CMA Pot Luck!

the potluck club

Reserve a date to host a Pot Luck dinner!

Available Dates:

November 12
December 10 or 17

Contact Rosemary Bigelow at
rosemary@mygrandmotherslace.com

Calling all Golfers

submitted by Rosemary Bigelow, O-5

The Robert Lowman Charitable Golf Tournament will be held September 26 at The Woods Golf Course in Hedgesville, WV. Come out for the golf, help a worthy cause, and remember a CMA community member.

Bob Lowman was a full time resident of CMA, an avid golfer, and a successful businessman. He was always looking for ways to have fun and do good. This golf tournament is the perfect way to honor his legacy and help others. Georgia Lowman continues to make her home at Coolfont and is strongly focused on fundraising for the Morgan County Homeless Coalition which is building the county's first permanent homeless shelter. To support this charity tournament, you can form a golf team to play or become a sponsor.

The Robert Lowman Memorial Golf Tournament will not only honor a very successful businessman from our community, but it will extend his legacy of helping others less fortunate by supporting the construction efforts of the MCHC- Hope House.

To participate as a sponsor or player, please contact Terri Felsen at dustinthewind@usa.com. Registration is required by September 10. All proceeds benefit the MCHC Hope House and year-round assistance to those who need help with homelessness.



"LOOP THE LOOP"

FAMILY FUN RUN AND WALK

11:30 AM SATURDAY
OCTOBER 1, 2022
(rain or shine)

On-site sign up begins at 11:00 AM.

PARTICIPATION FEE IS $0.00. Donations will be accepted that will go to the Sports Court Fund.

The course: The start will be at the CMA barn on Recreation Way. Choose to complete 1 loop or 2 loops of the Mountainside Road loop, then take Bluebird Lane down to the brewery and the finish line.

A water station will be available at the completion of the first loop. CMA neighbors are encouraged to set up a "cheer station" alongside the loop by your house as well as offering bottled water at their expense.

At the finish, enjoy one refreshing beverage of your choice at the brew pub. Hang out to celebrate with other participants and CMA friends and neighbors.

Please bring the "Loop the Loop" Registration Form on the next page with you.

Contact Travis Martz at travis@martzlegal.com or Mark Johnson at mfjrunbike@gmail.com.



Earthstar Mushrooms, Craig Deane (T-2)



Saving You $2.84!

by CMA Finance Committee

Over the past two years, your Finance Committee volunteers worked with the Morgan County Assessors office to review the real estate assessments on the Association's 11 parcels. These holdings are CMA's common area properties and the Association pays real estate taxes based on the assessments - just as owners pay taxes on the assessed value of their property. The assessments are based on various factors, including access, structures, improvements, market value, etc.

A careful review indicated that several of these parcels needed the assessment updated. In one case, the county allocated a small structure on an adjacent owner's lot to a CMA parcel.

The result of these assessment updates is a savings of nearly 7.5% over last year's total tax bill - a reduction of about $415 for annual real estate taxes or $2.84 per owner.

Your volunteer committee continues to look for efficiencies and other means to help keep Association costs as low as possible.

Coolfont Mountainside Association

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PARTICIPANT'S NAME (print): _____

ADDRESS: _____

CITY, STATE, ZIP: _____

PHONE: _____ EMAIL: _____

WAIVER: I am physically fit, able and have medical clearance to participant in the CMA "Loop the Loop" Family Fun Run and Walk. If I do participant, I, on behalf of myself, my heirs, and assigns hereby waive and forever discharge the event sponsors, organizers, and affiliates from any claims that may occur as a result of my participation. (This waiver must be signed to participate)

(Participants under 16 years old must have the consent of a parent or responsible adult sponsor)

Participant's Name (print): _____. Date: _____

Participant's signature or responsible adult sponsor: _____

PLEASE BRING THIS FORM WITH YOU TO THE EVENT!



Great spangled fritillary, Holz (F-1)

Beware of Dead Ash Trees!

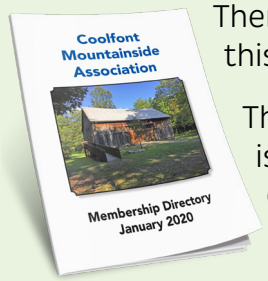
by Amy Gray, A-1

This monster ash tree fell unexpectedly on Friday, June 17 - a sunny afternoon while I was at the pool! I had been playing outside that morning in the driveway with Grand dog Boone, mowed the grass, and went to the pool. About 45 minutes later, Mike called me to come home - a tree had fallen on my new Bronco Sport! Fortunately, our auto insurance covered the loss and I found another vehicle last weekend. Can't be too careful! No one harmed was the best news of all.





Directory Updates



There are no directory updates for this quarter.

The Communications Committee is currently working on a new, online member directory. Details to follow.

Signs of Life

spotted by Rosemary Bigelow, O-4





Oriole Nest, Craig Deane (T-2)

Living with Snakes

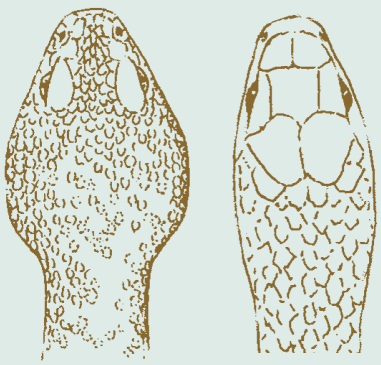
by Craig Deane (T-2) and Cathy Levey (A-6)
Adapted from Summer 2013 Newsletter

It is normal to see snakes in this area and they are a crucial part of the environment on the mountainside, helping to keep the rodent population under control. There are currently 22 species of snakes in West Virginia. Only two of those species are poisonous: the Northern Copperhead and the Timber Rattlesnake. All snakes are carnivores, feeding on small insects, earthworms, fish, rodents, frogs, lizards, birds, and other snakes. Most snakes spend much of their lives hidden under rocks and logs while some snakes also live near the water and in branches of trees. A couple nonvenomous snakes are very common in West Virginia, such as the Garter Snake and Black Rat Snake. Others, such as the Corn Snake and Northern Pine Snake, have been seen only a few times over the past several years.

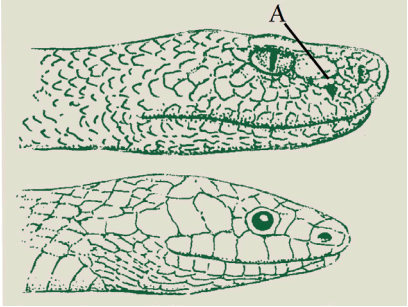
Venomous or Nonvenomous?

We can happily – and safely – live with our snake neighbors provided common sense rules of behavior are followed. First, snakes only attack when threatened. Most snake bites occur when people attempt to handle or molest them. Even venomous snakes are not particularly aggressive. To differentiate between venomous and nonvenomous snakes, look at the characteristics of their head – from a distance! Two obvious differences are the broad, arrow-shaped heads of the venomous snakes versus the slender, narrow heads of the nonvenomous snakes. You can also see the elliptical shape of the eye with a pit or opening of the venomous snake versus the round pupil of the nonvenomous snake with no pit or opening. These characteristics can be seen from several feet away – a safe distance for observing snakes. Snakes can only strike a distance of about half their body length. Snake bites are very rare and usually occur when people are not following basic precautions.

Venomous snakes (left) have broad, arrow-shaped heads with narrow necks. Nonvenomous snakes (right) have more slender heads.



Venomous snakes in West Virginia (top) have an elliptical pupil and a pit or opening (A) close to the nostril. Nonvenomous snakes (below) have a round pupil and no pit opening.



Graphics from ***Snakes of West Virginia***, WVDNR

Precautions

When walking the trails or hiking, wear long pants and hiking boots. Don't put your hands or feet where you can't see them. For example, never step over a log where you can't see the other side and don't walk through tall grass or damp areas where snakes are likely to hang out. Around your home, piles of debris and wood make good homes for mice, which attract the snakes. If you encounter a snake, the best approach is to leave it alone and it will most likely leave on its own accord. By staying informed and following basic precautions, our experience with our snake neighbors is not only non-threatening, it can also bring a sense of awe and wonder.

For More Information

Check out the WV Department of Natural Resources, Wildlife Resources Section, publication ***Snakes of West Virginia***, available at https://wvdnr.gov/wp-content/uploads/2021/05/SnakesofWV05.pdf.



Timber rattlesnake on Salmon Lane

Board Shorts

May Board Meeting

- Approved contract with Robert Snidemiller for cleaning of ditches and culverts
- Approved Mountainside Getaways for CPO duties, pool attendant management, and mowing and cleaning services
- Approved Site Manager contract with Mountain Home Real Estate
- Waived assessment late fees, finance charges for account as discussed in Executive Session
- Extended contract with Luke Arbogast for downed tree removal to December 31, 2022
- Waived late fees on March and June WS bills for account as discussed in Executive Session

June Board Meeting

- Postponed motion on Road Engineer Study pending additional information
- Extensive discussion on use of property document
- PSC has approved contract for Water/Sewer with WSPSD. Contract signed.

July Board Meeting

- Approved contract to remove dangerous trees from around pool area and sports courts
- Approved motion to dismantle/remove stairs to sports courts due to hazardous condition
- Agreed to suspend mowing of meadow and allow it to naturalize, mowing only access road as required
- Approved contract to remove remainder of downed tree from Whippoorwill Way
- More discussion on use of property document

Next Board Meeting is Saturday, August 13 at 10:00 am at Coolfont Resort

WOHOA
WEST VIRGINIA ORGANIZATION OF HOMEOWNERS ASSOCIATIONS
2022 MEMBER

2022 Board Calendar

Here are the dates for CMA meetings for the rest of the year. Please check the Google Group or Facebook Group for confirmation of date, time, and location.

- Board of Directors Meeting
  Saturday, August 13, 10:00 am
  Coolfont Resort
- Annual Membership Meeting
  Saturday, September 24, 10:00 am
  Coolfont Resort
- Board of Directors Meeting
  Monday, October 17, 6:30 pm
  Zoom teleconference
- Board of Directors Meeting
  Saturday, November 12, 10:00 am
  Coolfont Resort
- Board of Directors Meeting
  Monday, December 12, 6:30 pm
  Zoom teleconference

Coolfont Mountainside Association

P.O. Box 418, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411

Board of Directors
coolfont.board@gmail.com
Steve Katz, President
Eric Lienhard, Vice President
Susan Betts, Secretary
Dawne Holz, Treasurer
Lisa Johnson, Director
Travis Martz, Director
Cindy Van Meter, Director

Website
www.coolfontmountainside.org

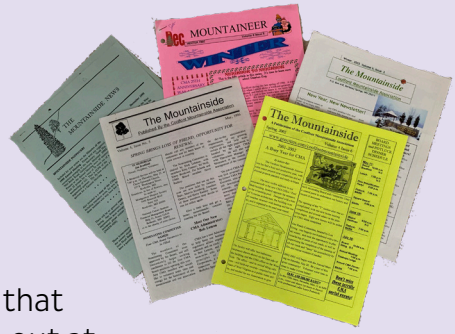
Google Group Email
cma-members@googlegroups.com

Google Group Signup/Web
groups.google.com/g/cma-members

Facebook Group
www.facebook.com/groups/257606361406

Winding Down

by Dawne Holz, Communications Committee



CMA newsletters have provided information to our members since at least 1976. They have been published sporadically since that time. (Check them out at coolfontmountainside.com/newsletters) Distributed in hard copy in its early years, the newsletter has been distributed electronically since Nov 2018.

The Fall 2022 newsletter will be the last issue of 'Round the Mountainside. Community news and updates will be communicated through the CMA Google Group and Facebook page. We will also keep the website calendar and posts current so owners can keep up with events.

Thank you to our members who have supported the newsletter with articles, photos, reviews, recipes, committee updates, and other information. Please continue to share these with other members through the Google group or our Facebook page.

COMMITTEES & CONTACTS

Our committees are staffed by volunteers. They welcome any assistance with projects and events. If you would like to help, please contact the committee chair.

Site Manager - Vacant

Communications - Dawne Holz
Facebook - Dawne Holz
703-362-6727 dawneholz@gmail.com
Google Group - Cindy Van Meter
703-532-6862 cndyvm@yahoo.com
Newsletter - Dawne Holz
703-362-6727 coolfont.news@gmail.com
Website - Jefferson Stovall
850-339-5279 jefferson.stovall@gmail.com

DACC - Dennis Daisey
202-834-0180 dennis.daisey@gmail.com

Finance - Dawne Holz, CMA Treasurer
703-362-6727 dawneholz@gmail.com

Firewise - Cindy Van Meter, Acting Chair
703-532-6862 cndyvm@yahoo.com

Infrastructure Mapping - VACANT

Neighborhood Watch - Steve Katz
304-258-9329 skatz844@aol.com

Nominations/Elections - Rusty McCrady
240-723-5930 rusty.mccrady@gmail.com

Recreation/Trails - Lisa Johnson, Board Liaison

Social - Holly Schetrompf & Kathy Katz
304-671-0882 almostheavenpm1@gmail.com
304-258-9329 kathyk717@aol.com

Welcome - Rosemary Bigelow
304-258-5352 rosemary@mygrandmotherslace.com

Water & Sewer

Chair - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Warm Springs Public Service District (WSPSD)
Mon - Fri, 9:00 am - 5:00 pm: 304-258-4118
All other times: Morgan County 304-258-0305

Join the CMA Facebook group!
www.facebook.com/groups/257606361406